

Accommodating for Success

Scouting supports and promotes full inclusion. **Most Scouts** with disabilities **participate in Traditional units** in their local communities. Some, due to family choice, peer group, or specialized needs/interests may join a Special Needs unit. In either environment, thoughtful planning and cooperation can ensure success along the Scouting path.

Accommodations are
individual,
situational
and **task specific.**



The needs of the Scout and the desired outcomes are the starting points. Unit activities not related to rank and advancement requirements allow for greater flexibility. Other situations may need to be accommodated in reference to the current Guide to Advancement.

Creativity, communication, planning, and follow through are the hallmarks for creating a **successful Scouting Journey**.

Looking for Support?

Delivering the Scouting Program to any Scout can be tremendously rewarding for volunteer leadership. While **each Scout is unique**, extra challenges may present themselves when working with Scouts with differing abilities and special needs. The BSA along with the National Special Needs and Disabilities Committee has compiled resources for unit leaders, district, and council volunteers and professionals, to assist in including youth of all abilities in Scouting programs.



General Interest

www.scouting.org/resources/disabilities

Able Scouts – ablescouts.org

Inclusion Toolbox – ablescouts.org

Abilities Digest: facebook.com/abilitiesdigest

Advancement Specific

Guide to Advancement

Scouting.org/resources/guide-to-advancement

Refer to sections on Rank, Merit Badges, Registration, and Individual Scout Advancement Plan



Seeking Inspiration?

The National Special Needs and Disability Committee has developed an online reference tool. The **Inclusion Toolbox** is an easy to use, searchable, and updatable source of Special Needs information. Created in collaboration with a wide range of medical, educational, and special needs experts, it provides information related to **specific disabilities and Scouting concerns**. This is the place to go if you have questions. Find ideas for supporting the needs of Scouts with differing abilities. Discover ways to address camping, health, safety, waterfront, organizational and many more Scout related concerns.



Toolbox link
QR

Why Join Scouting?

Scouts BSA is one of nation's prominent **values-based** youth development organizations.

It provides **growth opportunities** for:

- Character building,
- Citizenship and Service
- Interest based skills
- Physical fitness,
- Leadership,
- Social skills,
- STEAM

Since 1910 the BSA has helped to enhance the lives of individuals, families, and communities by combining educational activities and lifelong **values with fun**.

Guided by the **Scout Oath and Law**, it is the Vision of the BSA, to prepare every eligible youth in America (regardless of gender) to become the **best**, most responsible citizen **they can be**.



Involvement in Scouts BSA Programs contribute to building a more **responsible, productive, and inclusive society**.

You are invited to join!

Interested? Have Questions?

Please Contact

Space for local contact information



BSA National Special Needs and
Disabilities Committee

[www.scouting.org/resources/disabilities-
awareness](http://www.scouting.org/resources/disabilities-awareness)
specialneedschair@scouting.org

Scout Us All In!



Join us for

Lasting Friendships

Fun and adventure

Character Development

Skills and Learning

Family Fun

A history of Inclusion

The BSA is a Values-based youth development program that has **included youth with** emotional, mental, and physical disabilities since its founding. We continue to be committed to expanding resources that support a successful Scouting journey for youth with both **visible and invisible disabilities**. Environmental adaptations, varied instructional methods, and mindful planning can support meaningful participation in



Scouting starting at
**age five through
adulthood** as
appropriate.

National Special Needs and Disabilities
Committee Boy Scouts of America

[www.scouting.org/resources/disabilities-
awareness](http://www.scouting.org/resources/disabilities-awareness)